

by methods like hypnotherapy, still others who claim to have some kind of magic formula, but the breakaway bible for habit change in the last few years is undoubtedly James Clear's *Atomic Habits*.¹ His ideas around breaking old habits and building better ones are based around making changes in tiny increments, rather than pushing for huge, unsustainable changes right from the offset. He also has some set methods for building and breaking habits that can be applied beautifully to looking after your financial wellbeing.

His basic principles, as well as building on small changes, revolve around tuning your brain to reject the old habit and embrace the new, using practical and mindset techniques. He advocates making habits that you want to phase out **invisible**, **unattractive**, **difficult** and **unsatisfying**, while making the habits that you want to adopt **obvious**, **attractive**, **easy** and **satisfying**. So, let's talk about how we can apply some of these methods to financial wellbeing.

Think about some undesirable or damaging money habits that you want to break. This could be things like overspending each month or dipping into your savings, or they could be more deeply associated with your financial wellbeing, such as feeling guilty if you spend on non-essentials or spending more than you can afford in order to please people. Making these habits **invisible** could mean removing shopping apps from your devices, or putting savings in an account that doesn't allow immediate withdrawals. Making them **unattractive** could mean pinning a list of the benefits of avoiding these